

TEN MINUTES · ONCE A WEEK · COMPOUNDS ALL YEAR

The 10-minute AI habit

You don't learn AI in a summer workshop. You learn it ten minutes at a time, on real tasks, until it's just how you work. This sheet is the whole system: one calendar slot, one task a week, one running doc of prompts that worked. By winter break you'll have a personal toolkit no PowerPoint could have given you.

The habit, in three moves

- **1 · Same slot every week.** Put ten minutes on your calendar now — same day, same time, attached to something you already do (planning period, Friday coffee). If it isn't scheduled, it isn't a habit; it's an intention.
- **2 · One task, not "learn AI."** Each week, pick a single real task from the ladder below — something you were going to do anyway. Run it with AI. Compare against how long it usually takes.
- **3 · Save what worked.** Keep one running doc titled "Prompts that worked." When a prompt saves you twenty minutes, paste it in with a one-line note. This doc becomes the most valuable planning file you own.

THE RULE RIDES ALONG, EVERY WEEK

Never put student personally identifiable information into a public AI tool.

Describe the need, not the child.

The eight-week starter ladder

Climb in order or jump around — each rung is one week's ten minutes, with a prompt to start from.

Week	Try this task
1 · Parent message	"Draft a warm note to families about [TOPIC]. Under 120 words, one clear action step." Rewrite it in your voice; notice what you kept.
2 · Level a text	"Rewrite this passage at a [GRADE] reading level, keeping the key vocabulary: [PASTE]." Compare it to the original like an editor.
3 · Exit tickets	"Write five exit-ticket questions on [TOPIC] for [GRADE], from recall to 'explain why.' Include an answer key."
4 · The email you're dreading	Have AI draft the reply you keep postponing (no names in the prompt — describe the situation generally). Edit until it sounds like you.
5 · Differentiate one task	"Create three versions of this activity — more scaffolding, on level, extension: [PASTE]." You match versions to students; it never knows who they are.

6 · Rubric in minutes	"Create a 4-level rubric for [ASSIGNMENT], criteria: [3–4 CRITERIA], written so a [GRADE] student can self-assess."
7 · Sub plans, before you need them	"Write a one-page substitute plan for [GRADE/TOPIC]: bell-ringer, main activity with numbered directions, early-finisher task." File it. Future-you says thanks.
8 · Your reusable template	Take your best prompt so far and turn the specifics into [BRACKETS]. That's a template you'll reuse all year — the whole game in one move.

Your tracker

Print this page, clip it inside your planner, and give each week one honest line. "Keep / tweak / drop" is the only review that matters.

Week	Task I tried	Time it saved	Keep / tweak / drop — and why
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Prompts that worked (start the doc here)

Ready for the next step? When ten minutes a week starts paying off, our complete AI PD sessions and time-saver packs are in our TpT store — including a Back-to-School AI Setup Pack that gets your whole year configured in one planning period.

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